

PREMISE DELTA v0.3 (THE TRUSTING FORGERY): DISPOSITION • 2026-09-09

Two independent adversaries attacked the same frozen text of four-keys-premise-delta-trusting-forgery-v0.3-2026-09-08.md. Fable: REWORK, high confidence (...-attack-fable-2026-09-08.md). GPT: REJECT, high confidence (...-attack-chatgpt-2026-09-08.md). This table merges both, in order of fatality, with my concurrence and a provisional in-world answer where I have one. Author positions are hypotheses; the check is the table. Stephen's standard: hard evidence kills a premise, a count of objections does not. Walked with Stephen one row at a time from 2026-09-09; the Status column records his ruling. v8.1 remains in force.

The tests applied to every answer

An answer counts only if it is a fact the story can show (not a sentence in a letter), it does not arm a new early ender, and it is not equally an exposure of v8.1 that three rounds already passed (in which case it is noted as "not new evidence against v0.3" and carried to the spine's own list).

The table

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
1	Brad's Day o least-cost action. Knowing a letter and an object sit behind a new padlock, he defeats the lock and destroys them before Day 14 rather than wait.	Serious (picking moves the swap earlier and deletes the dawn sighting)	Fatal; the verdict's driver	Partly. The delta did not answer it, and should have. But the premise of the finding is wrong for this man.	Waiting costs him nothing: nobody else can open the store before the keys arrive either, so unread evidence behind a lock is inert for fourteen days. A cut or damaged lock is the one event in the story that makes the police look: four people arrive with keys to an empty store under a broken padlock, a week after a letter told them to read what was there together, and the intruder she described becomes a fact on a police file. Brad's whole method, from the tin to the stairs to the swap, is that nothing is ever visibly wrong. Substitution is his least-cost action precisely because it leaves everything as she left it. Picking without a trace: the padlock is a closed-shackle marine padlock (cannot be shimmed), picking is a skill he does not have and cannot practise on hers, and the sheds are worked from first light every day, so an earlier visit carries the same witness and a night visit with a torch is the one that gets remembered. His own locker beside hers is a reason to be there at seven; it is no reason to be there at two in the morning. The delta needs one line on the padlock and one on his method; the ruling stands.	Accepted 09-09

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
2	Chapter 7 is an inference. The forgery calls its list "a starter list, to show you what I mean"; rulings 2 and 7 give Violet innocent reasons for both omissions; "known to the town" contradicts "only Brad and Margo"; Ally holds both streams by chapter 6.	Fatal to the claim; the verdict's driver	Fatal	Yes, on every part. The contradiction is mine: the café knows the debts were being called in (spine row 56); only Margo knows from whom and how much.	Corrected in the walk: the dawn sighting reaches Ally in chapter 4 (row 177) and cannot be chapter 7's fact. Chapter 7's fact is the solicitor's covering slip and postmark (row 295, already ch7): four envelopes posted together on the Saturday, three to home addresses and one to a box number. A box is cleared first thing; home delivery came after work. One of the four held his key by seven and the boat owner saw him use it at 07:20. The letter read at nine that night had been in his hands since morning, with a day at her bench between. Document and witness agree on a time; one man is named without a word about handwriting. The omissions are what he did with the fourteen hours: consequences, not the turn. "To show you what I mean" goes. Ruling 2 re-cut: the town knows she was calling in money; Margo alone knows the names and the sums.	Accepted 09-09: the box number
3	Violet's engine: the scale of the machinery. A dead-man mechanism presupposes danger; the forgery cut the tin and left the machinery standing on a shelf; "loose lid" survives in the ban; the solicitor could have heard the concern; pride does not survive two peers saying "yours".	Serious, near fatal	Fatal	Partly. The forgery's gap is real and the "loose lid" is my drafting. The solicitor point and the dead-man point apply to v8.1 equally (C1 row -3 passed three rounds).	Her true letter keeps the tin; the scale of her machinery is hers and it is proportionate to a poisoning. The forgery must keep a reason for the scale in her voice that is neither a poisoning nor a name; candidate, from her own letter: if I'm dead and it wasn't my heart or my stairs, then I wasn't imagining it, and you'll want to know what I noticed. On Brad and the panel: she never taught him to lay leaf, so the one hand trained in her alphabet cannot gild; that is a judgement about a hand, not a suspicion, and it is why the trade's "yours" does not send her to him. Ruled: the true letter keeps the tin and the one-line exclusion (it isn't Brad's, I never taught him leaf); the forgery drops the lid and carries her reason for the scale in her voice (I don't think I'm going to die, I think I'm going to be sixty and embarrassed; if I'm wrong nobody needs to know, if I'm right you'll want to know what I noticed; if I'd told you now you'd have sat in my kitchen with a torch). Solicitor and dead-man points to the spine's list.	Accepted 09-09

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
4	Margo. Day 8: the missing book goes to the executor or Del, not the sister (GPT). Day 19 to Day 51: she holds every element and nothing arrives (Fable). Brad kills her over an ambiguous omission (GPT).	Serious	Fatal	Partly. Day 8 is also v8.1's row 232, never attacked because the book was not load-bearing there; it is now. Day 19 to 51 is real. The killing-over-silence point is v8.1's rows 122 to 125 unchanged.	Day 8: the sister is the executor (one line), and a notebook Margo cannot find in a locked house is not a missing record; her own file is the record. Day 19 to 51: the trigger is the room's verdict (Day 47): a reading acquires consequences when it is about to convict a friend, and that is when she re-reads the letter for what is missing rather than what is there. Ruled in the walk: the van money was lent on no paper by Violet's own choice (row 61: Margo said yes, Violet did not); Margo's Day -120 note is a note of a conversation, not a receivable; the sister is the executor (one line); closing the books for probate Margo writes "no receivables evidenced", her own omission and the story's mirror. The Day 51 arrival is the probate accounts (sister asks around Day 40): the autumn as a ledger, nothing in from him, the note in her file, the room about to convict Liam. Brad's read of her silence is v8.1 unchanged; he alone knows what she holds.	Accepted 09-09
5	The room. "Who had her key" is the first question (GPT); Liam's line "she wrote it wasn't me" is unavoidable and unwritten (Fable); the three-weeks arithmetic (GPT).	Serious	Fatal	Yes that the room must be staged, not asserted.	The spare in the meter box is the first thing they check on Day 15 and it is there, which under v0.3 is worse: someone knew where it lives, and all four do. Ruled in the walk: Day 15, Liam answers the key question because he found her: front locked, back latched, the spare still in the meter box, a place five people knew and one is dead. That sentence crosses out "it isn't any of you" with a locked house, not a character reading. Ruby's line at meeting one, unanswered: she thought she'd know, and she's dead. Liam lands because the list is about him and he alone has a history in that house (the mother, the last week, the bedroom, the catch); the room hears ordinary as practised. Written meeting by meeting, never asserted. Open: within a month.	Accepted 09-09
6	The sister and the ashes. She gains access Day 5 and asks where her mother is; none of the four can answer before Day 14 (GPT). Day 0 attenders saw the tube (Fable).	Serious	Fatal	Fable misread canon: Liam found her on Day 1 and the tube left at 22:30 on Day 0. GPT's point stands if the sister knew the shelf.	One ruled line: the sister has not been inside Violet's house in four years and does not know the shelf; she takes the barrel and the keys on Day 5 and leaves the rooms for a clearance months later, at which point she assumes the scattering. Ruled in the walk: the sister asked once after the funeral and Violet said I'll take her out to the point; she has believed it done since and has not been in the house in four years (dispute since Day -1200). Day 5 she takes the barrel and the keys and leaves the rooms for a clearance months later. If she ever asks the survivors after Day 14 they say what the letter says, and she waits. Nothing ends early on any branch.	Accepted 09-09

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
7	Liam's two requests. "He didn't ask why" is Violet's side only; Liam explains on night one and the explanation is ordinary.	Serious	Serious, fatal to the decoy as built	Yes.	Brad may salt only with what Liam cannot dispute. Liam explains on night one, and the room later reads his own explanation (I wanted her off that shelf) as the motive. The salt is the fact, not the gloss. Ruled: bare fact only in every salted item (the boat, the yard, the marathon); no opinion of hers the room was not present for. Liam's truthful explanation on night one is what a room holding the meter box hears as practised. The decoy is built on the room being frightened, not on Liam being suspicious.	Accepted 09-09
8	Ruby to Del on Day 15. An intruder report licenses a key inquiry and a sheds canvass that finds the dawn witness (GPT); the ban is the forger's tell (Fable).	Serious	Fatal	Check R27's terms: a canvass of a document's finding place needs a tampering hypothesis. An intruder report on a closed accident is not one. Under v8.1 C3 row 3 passed on the same ground.	If R27 holds as written, Del takes a statement, the letter is examined (consistent), the coroner's officer finds no act, the house is re-read (locked front and back), and nobody goes to the sheds. The ban as tell: keep it, and let Ruby flag it on the record in chapter 2; it is what Ally re-hears in chapter 7. Ruled: hold as v8.1 on Day 15 (row 25, R27); the story survives either branch (if she goes, the letter comes back stamped hers, which certifies the forgery); the survivors' first police visit stays in the week after the second death.	Accepted 09-09
9	"The ninth." A dated intrusion is investigable and clears Liam (GPT); the date must clear every visitor (Fable).	Cosmetic to serious	Serious	Yes.	The forgery gives no date: one morning last month. More in her voice, and nothing to alibi against. Ruled: there is no ninth; the delta's pin requirement is withdrawn; a vague letter sends the room back to access, the meter box and the one man with a history in the house.	Accepted 09-09
10	The first minute. A summary, not a hook; no present danger inside sixty seconds.	Serious	Fatal	Testable, and the point that the ruled open holds a present danger is fair.	Three blind readers, as ruled. The tin may belong in the minute. Not decided on paper. Ruled: accepted as testable and unproven; two versions of the middle (ruling 6 as sketched; and one with "only two of them are still alive" and the tin's image inside sixty seconds) go to the three readers with v0.4 as control; one question at the minute mark, unprompted: what are you afraid of right now.	Accepted 09-09 as a test

What is not new evidence against v0.3 (carried to the spine's own list)

Whether Violet would tell her solicitor rather than lodge envelopes (C1 row –3). Whether Margo reports a notebook she cannot find (row 232). Whether Brad would kill Margo over a silence (rows 122 to 125). Each was in v8.1 and passed three rounds; if any of them is a hole, it is a hole in the story, not in the delta.

Outcome of the walk, 2026-09-09

All ten rows walked with Stephen, one at a time, and accepted with the answers recorded in the Status column. Neither driver survived its own premise: GPT's assumed a damaged lock is cheaper for Brad than an unread

letter, which inverts his method; Fable's was a real fault in the v0.3 drafting, and the fact that replaces it (the box number, from the solicitor's slip already placed in chapter 7) is canon since v1.7. Rows 3 to 10 were rework, and are reworked. The corrected premise is written as **delta vo.4** (four-keys-premise-delta-trusting-forgery-v0.4-2026-09-09.md) and goes back to both adversaries fresh, with this disposition attached so they attack the answers and not the questions. v8.1 remains in force until v0.4 has survived that round and Stephen rules.

Verdict, provisional, before the walk (kept for the record)

Neither adversary's driver survives its own premise: GPT's assumes a damaged lock is cheaper for Brad than an unread letter, which inverts his method; Fable's is a real fault in my drafting and has a canon fact to replace it. Rows 3 to 10 are rework, not walls. That is my hypothesis; the walk is the check, and Stephen rules each row.